

# Product Requirements Document

VentureNest: an intelligent, approval-led workspace that helps founders turn a startup idea into a credible plan and an executable operating system.

Version 1.0 | Made by DEX

Prepared from the Project VISTA source brief

## PRD

A coherent operating blueprint for an intelligent startup workspace.

## 1. Product Definition

VentureNest is a web application for early-stage founders and small startup teams. It converts structured inputs into editable business artifacts, research briefs, brand directions, forecasts, and actionable work plans. It is an assistive system: the user owns the final decision and explicitly approves any outward-facing or persistent artifact.

**Product promise: move from an uncertain idea to an organised, reviewable startup plan without juggling disconnected tools.**

## 2. Problem and Opportunity

- Founders repeat the same framing, research, planning, and financial-model setup across documents and tools.
- Generic AI output often lacks traceability, context, version control, and a route into actual execution.
- Early teams need structured guidance without being locked into a rigid business-plan template.

## 3. Goals and Non-goals

| Goals                                                                | Not in the MVP                                                            |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Create high-quality editable startup artifacts from a project brief. | Autonomously filing legal documents, sending messages, or spending money. |
| Make assumptions, sources, versions, and approvals visible.          | Replacing professional legal, tax, accounting, or investment advice.      |
| Turn plans into prioritised tasks and measurable next actions.       | A public marketplace, investor matching, or full CRM.                     |
| Support a small team working in one shared workspace.                | Real-time co-editing beyond comments and review status.                   |

## 4. Users and Jobs to Be Done

| User          | Primary job                               | Success moment                                                     |
|---------------|-------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Founder       | Validate and shape a startup concept      | Leaves with a defensible plan, a first forecast, and next actions. |
| Collaborator  | Contribute expertise and review artifacts | Can comment, revise, and see what needs approval.                  |
| Administrator | Manage access and system safety           | Can manage membership, usage, and audit history.                   |

## 5. MVP Scope

| Capability           | MVP behaviour                                                                                              | Acceptance signal                                                     |
|----------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Project intake       | Guided setup captures idea, audience, problem, geography, stage, and constraints.                          | A project is created with required fields and editable assumptions.   |
| Business plan studio | Generates editable sections: problem, solution, market, model, traction, go-to-market, risks, and roadmap. | User can regenerate a section, compare versions, approve, and export. |

| Capability         | MVP behaviour                                                                            | Acceptance signal                                                         |
|--------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Research workspace | Creates a research brief, SWOT, competitor hypotheses, and source-backed findings.       | Every sourced claim displays a URL, retrieval date, and confidence state. |
| Brand kit          | Produces name directions, voice, palette guidance, and logo brief; assets remain drafts. | User can select and approve one direction.                                |
| Financial planner  | Models revenue, costs, cash runway, and scenarios from transparent assumptions.          | Changing an assumption recalculates the selected scenario.                |
| Execution board    | Turns approved priorities into tasks with owner, due date, and status.                   | Tasks are filterable by project, owner, and status.                       |

## 6. Critical User Flows



*The approval state is a deliberate control point: AI output is never treated as final merely because it was generated.*

## 7. Functional Requirements

- FR-01: Users can create an organisation, invite collaborators, and create projects.
- FR-02: Every AI generation stores its prompt context, model metadata, inputs, output, cost/usage metadata, and approval status.
- FR-03: Users can edit generated artifacts and retain revision history.
- FR-04: Research claims support source links and may be marked verified, unverified, or disputed.
- FR-05: Financial calculations show the formulas and assumptions that drive each result.
- FR-06: All project data is exportable in PDF and structured formats.
- FR-07: The system records security-relevant changes in an immutable audit log.

## 8. Quality, Metrics, and Release

| Area              | Target                                                                       |
|-------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Usability         | A new founder creates a project and approves a first plan within 30 minutes. |
| Reliability       | 99.5% monthly availability for the application; recoverable async jobs.      |
| Performance       | Core pages load in under 2.5 seconds on a typical broadband connection.      |
| North-star metric | Weekly active projects with one approved artifact and one completed task.    |

| Area           | Target                                                                                                    |
|----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Launch metrics | Project activation, artifact approval rate, task completion, 7/28-day retention, generation failure rate. |

## 9. Delivery Plan

| Phase                | Outcome                                                          | Indicative duration |
|----------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| Foundation           | Auth, organisation/project model, design system, audit baseline. | 2 weeks             |
| Core planning        | Intake, business-plan studio, AI generation history.             | 3 weeks             |
| Research and finance | Source-backed research, forecast assumptions and scenarios.      | 3 weeks             |
| Brand and execution  | Brand-kit workflow, task board, exports.                         | 2 weeks             |
| Hardening            | Accessibility, security review, QA, analytics, beta rollout.     | 2 weeks             |